and that this is what has caused the increased absence of the state. Aid politics with a neoliberal agenda has certainly reinforced the absence of the state, but it did not cause it.

6 See Tankel (2016); Lieven (2011); Fair (2008).

7 Not mentioning the two-year rule of Yahya Khan here.

8 Where the pseudo despot was more interested in providing social goods than his democratic counterparts.

9 One could argue that the government under Musharraf was closer to a social contract model than the democratically elected governments before and after. This is explored later in this chapter.

10 This focus group included participants from Lahore.

11 For more on how globalization changes the nature of the state in South Asia see Lall and Nambissan (2011).

12 World Economic Forum (2017).

13 In Pakistan a middle class as such does not exist. This is why the term 'middle *classes*' is preferred as it allows the inclusion of a wide variety of groups that range from urban white-collar workers to rural land-owning families (not including the feudal lords who own large parts of Sindh and the Southern Punjab). The term is used here to refer to the classes who can provide the basic necessities, from education to health, for their own families without recourse to the state and whose children do not need to work.

14 Poverty in Pakistan is not easily measured as even the Gini index data varies between various official websites. Increasingly the Multidimensional Poverty Index is used (as in the 2010 UNDP Human Development Report) and details found in Naveed and Islam's RECOUP paper give some details on the various and combined depravations faced by ordinary Pakistanis (http://recoup.educ.cam.ac.uk/publications/WP28_Arif.pdf). Another problem is that of transitory poor – where families are living under the poverty line for just a part of the year. According to a study conducted by the Centre for Research on Poverty and Income Distribution (CRPID), '63 per cent of poor in Pakistan fall in the category of "transitory poor". The remaining 32 per cent and five per cent of the population that subsist below the poverty line are "chronic" and "extremely poor", respectively.'

15 A political party.

16 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

17 This focus group included participants from Lahore, Sheikhupura, Muridke, Dera Ghazi Khan and Sargodha.

18 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

19 This direct form of asking was chosen deliberately by the research team after a pilot study conducted with more general questions about the state resulted in surprise that anyone wanted to discuss the state at all. In discussion and in the qualitative